

ELDA COMMAND

Experiential Leadership Development Activity

NZ Army Leadership Centre | Army Command School

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ELDA Command develops leaders who can perform, adapt and influence others under operational pressure. Rather than teaching leadership in a classroom, it exposes leadership behaviour through demanding physical, mental and interpersonal challenge, then converts that experience into lasting behavioural change. Every participant leaves with a written Leadership Development Plan grounded in observed behaviour rather than self-perception.

Leadership behaviour is most accurately revealed under sustained pressure, uncertainty and fatigue. ELDA deliberately creates those conditions, then uses structured reflection and peer feedback to convert experience into enduring behavioural change.

AIM

To develop leaders who can consistently perform, adapt and influence others under pressure, while strengthening individual effectiveness and collective team performance.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

1 PERFORMANCE MINDSET

Build the mental skills to perform and decide under pressure.

2 THE ACTIVITY

Lead and follow through a genuinely demanding serial.

3 DEVELOPMENT PLAN

Transfer observed behaviour into command effectiveness.

HOW IT IS STRUCTURED: THE PERFORMANCE CYCLE

PREPARE

- Leadership Personality Report: a Five Factor profile of behaviour day to day, under pressure, and the drivers behind it.
- Identify the behaviours that will help and hinder performance.
- Select the mental skills to be used during the activity.

PERFORM

- Execute the activity as a team under sustained physical and mental load.
- Apply the selected behaviours and mental skills in real time.
- Peers observe leadership behaviour continuously, in context.

RECOVER

- Structured self and peer feedback, written then delivered face to face.
- Systematic self-reflection on the hardest moments of the activity.
- Build the Leadership Development Plan and keep, stop, start Game Plan.

WHAT IS COVERED

Leadership fundamentals

Command, management and leadership as distinct functions. The four pillars of trust: competence, predictability, benevolence and integrity. Identity against reputation, and the four competency domains.

Leadership Personality Report

A validated Five Factor instrument reporting day to day behaviour, behaviour under pressure or with the guard down, and the needs and drivers behind it.

Self and peer feedback

Every participant gives and receives specific behavioural feedback on one strength to sustain and one behaviour to adapt, evidenced by what was observed during the activity.

Performance under pressure

Red head and blue head, performance as potential less interference, and a mental-skills set: noticing, grounding, tactical breathing, self-talk, visualisation, chunking and recovery habits.

Leadership Development Plan

Three leadership behaviours to sustain and three to adapt, converted into keep, stop and start strategies that are effective, actionable and observable, then disclosed to the team.

WHAT A UNIT GETS BACK

- Leadership behaviour assessed under real load, not self-reported.
- Every leader returns with a written plan for behavioural adaptation.
- Each leader holds peer evidence of how their behaviour actually lands.
- Nested in the NZDF Leadership Framework, Lead Self to Lead Organisation.

DELIVERED BY THE NZ ARMY LEADERSHIP CENTRE. ELDA Command is developed and delivered by the NZ Army Leadership Centre as part of the Army Command School. It integrates validated psychometrics, evidence-based performance psychology and experiential leadership development within the NZDF Leadership Framework.

NZALC welcomes the opportunity to tailor an ELDA Command serial to 2nd Commando Regiment's operational context and leadership priorities. Initial scoping would confirm participant profile, activity design, delivery model and support requirements.